

How to Manage Culture Change to Maximize IAM Success

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Challenge: Culture!



Enterprise culture is the main barrier for IT-related change

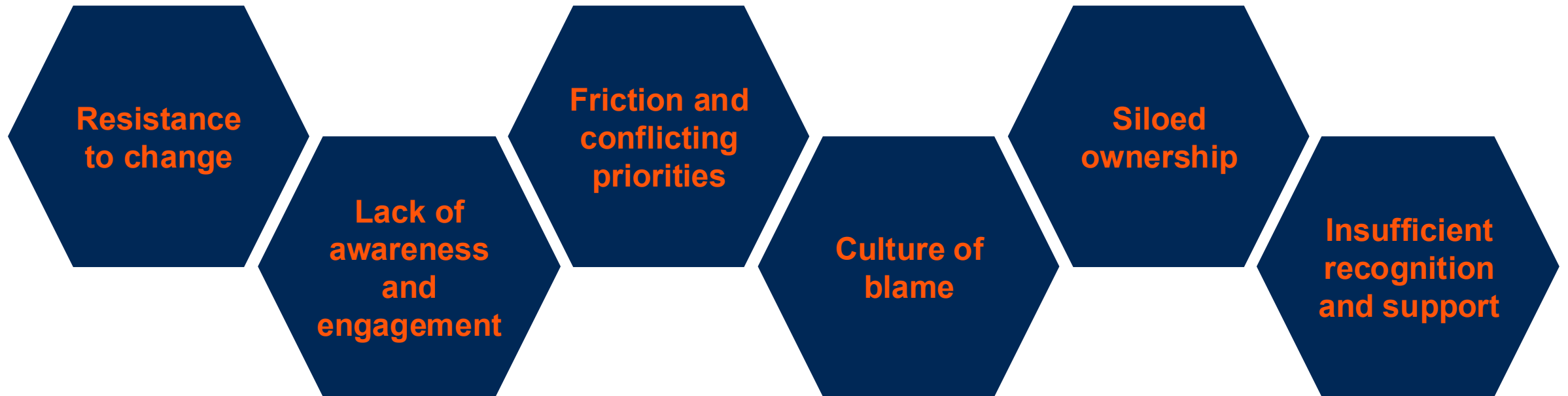
58%

Of respondents said enterprise culture is the biggest barrier to IT-related changes in the company.

IAM controls are everywhere, and they often require user interaction.

And it has several implications for organizational culture.

What Are the Cultural Challenges in IAM?



Three Key Strategies to Effectively Manage Culture Change in IAM Initiatives



Assess the current culture for a security-first alignment



Raise awareness and support empowerment



Foster a culture that values IAM

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Challenge

What could we do to address these?



Resistance to change

Involve employees early in the process, listen to their concerns and address them.



Lack of awareness and engagement

Launch awareness campaigns that explain IAM in relatable, non-technical terms.



Friction and conflicting priorities

Gather feedback from users to identify pain points and improve workflows.



Insufficient recognition and support

Make recognition part of the company culture, not just a one-time event.



Culture of blame

Frame IAM as a way to empower and protect employees, not to catch them out.



Siloed ownership

Involve leaders from across the business in IAM planning and decision-making.

Make the Most of Your Resources

**Gather and
act on employee
feedback**

**Leverage
(or champion)
a steering
committee**

**Consider
cybersecurity
champions**

If you can't clearly explain why you're asking people to change their behavior, you're missing a crucial piece of any successful culture change strategy.

Examples, of Personal Change “Whys” for IAM Initiatives



**You will need a clear and compelling
“why” that motivates people to connect
with and embrace your message.**

Key Issue Take-Away:

Change is personal and uncomfortable, which makes it emotional. That's why it's essential to give people a compelling “why” behind the shift.

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Insecure Employee Behavior Isn't Caused by a Lack of Cybersecurity Awareness

69%

of employees bypassed their organization's cybersecurity guidance.

74%

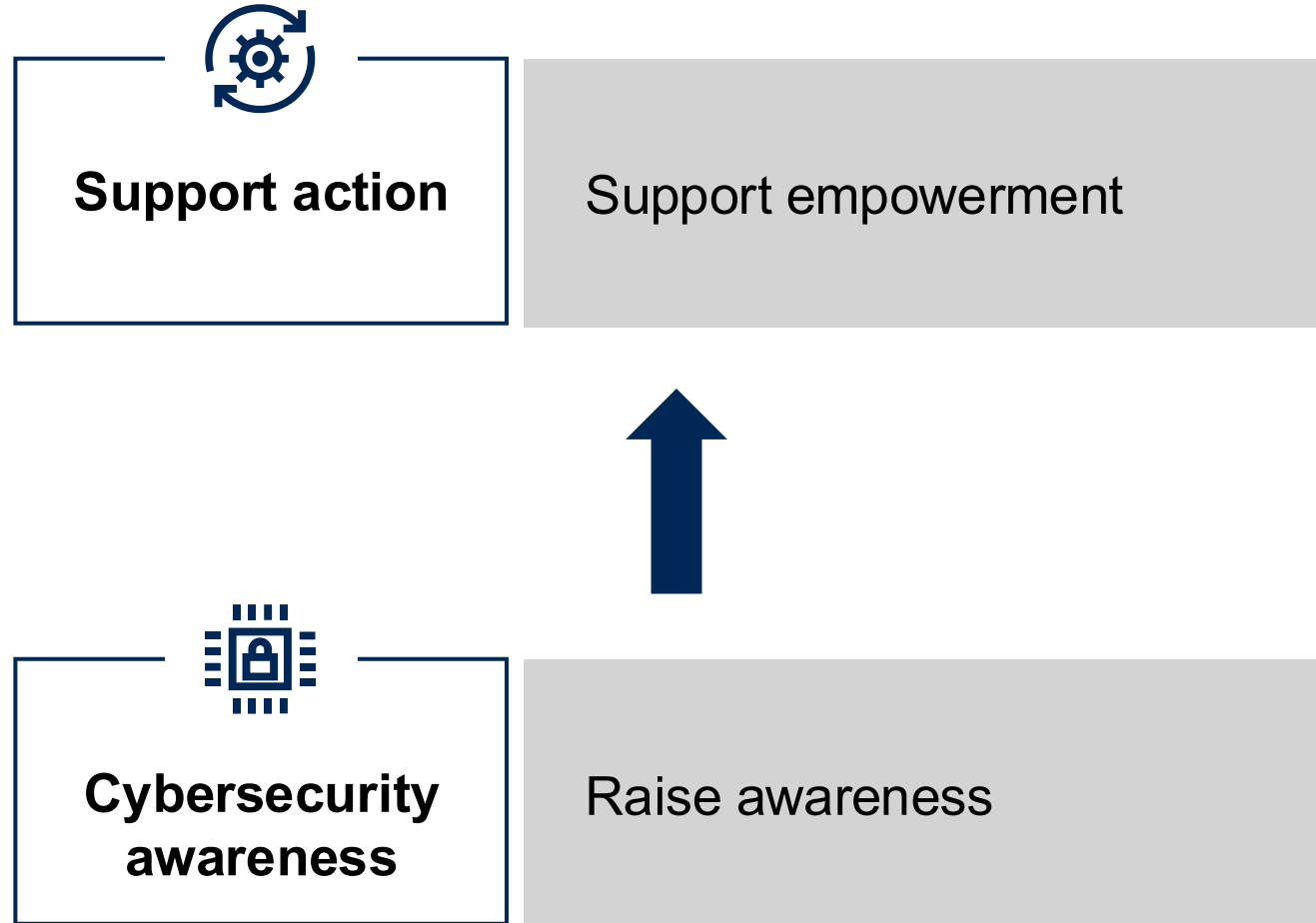
said that they would be willing to do so in the future too, if it helped them or their team achieve a business objective.

Awareness

Empowerment

Source: 2022 Gartner Drivers Of Secure Behavior Survey

Engaging People Is a Journey



Key Issue Take-Away:

Transitioning from awareness to empowerment requires time and different approaches. By building understanding of these methods, we can better deliver them to our audiences.

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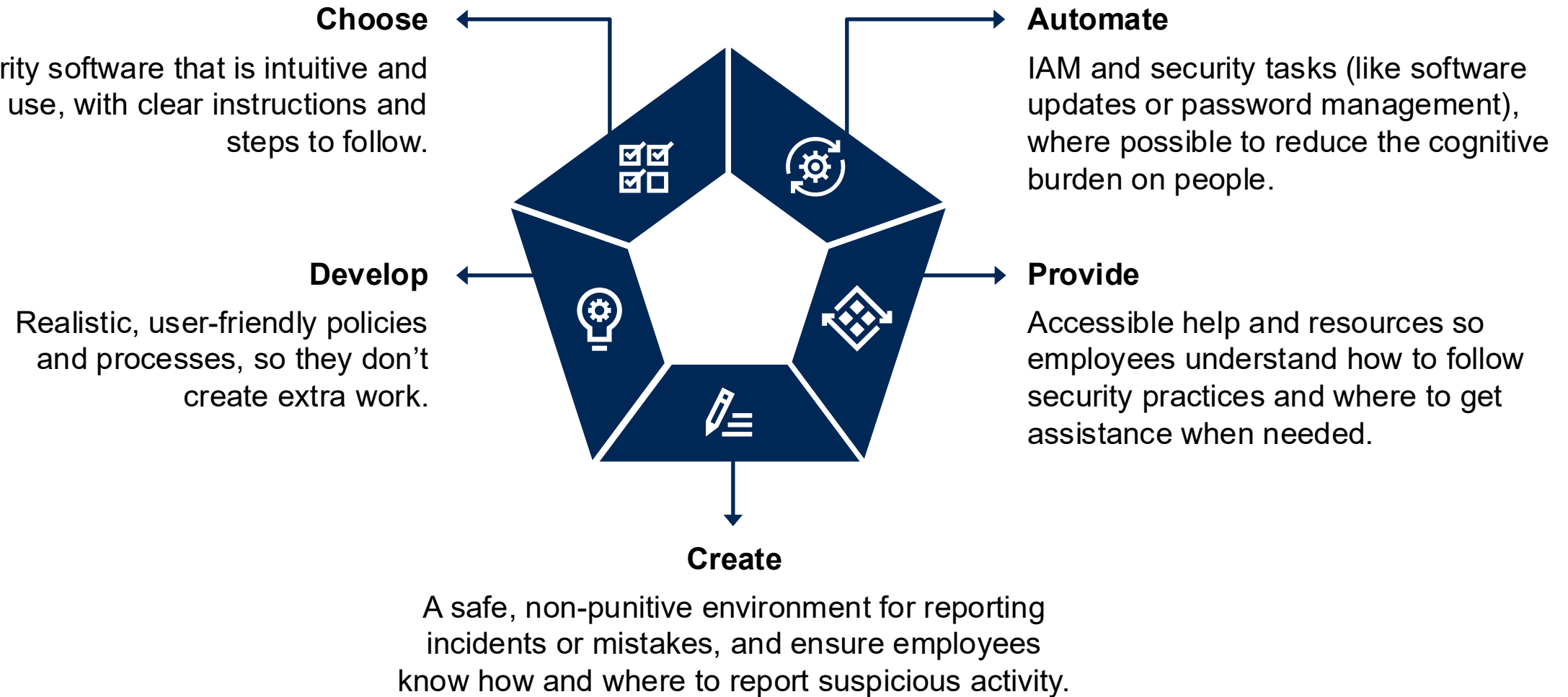


**Foster a culture
that values IAM**

Build a Culture of Positive, Human-Centric IAM



Make It Easy for People to Behave in a Secure Way



**Make the secure way the
path of least resistance.**

**Remove unnecessary complexity,
automate wherever possible and
design workflows so users do the
right thing by default.**

Recognize and Reward Good Cybersecurity Behavior

Examples of recognizing and rewarding good security behavior can include but are not limited to:

- 1 Personalized thank-you's** Personalized feedback highlighting their positive impact, a direct message from leadership.
- 2 Tangible rewards** Like gift cards, certificates or extra time off to those who consistently demonstrate good security habits.
- 3 Gamification** Points, badges, and leaderboards for secure behaviors, such as reporting phishing emails or completing security training.
- 4 Providing direct feedback** And appreciation from managers or security teams when employees make good security choices.
- 5 Career advancement** Adding "Security Champions" to performance reviews or LinkedIn profiles, opportunity to join special security projects or task forces.
- 6 Learning and development** Invitations to security conferences or webinars

Key Issue Take-Away:

Changing behavior is hard and like learning anything new it takes time, patience and persistence.

Just like any learning journey, building a strong IAM culture requires giving people the time and support they need to adopt the right behaviors.

Recommendations

- ④ **Assess** your organization's current culture by focusing on how integrated IAM is within your overall enterprise security strategy.
- ④ **Raise** awareness and empower your teams by simplifying your tools, processes and policies. This means simplifying the things that teach people what they need to do to exhibit the desired security behaviors.
- ④ **Build** a culture of positive, human-centric IAM by making it easy for people to follow IAM best practices and recognizing their security efforts and participation in IAM initiatives.

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James Hoover and Nayara Sangiorgio

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Nayara Sangiorgio

🔍 [Use Outcome-Driven Metrics to Drive Value for Identity and Access Management](#)

Rebecca Archambault and Paul Proctor

🔍 [5 Steps to Change the Culture of Your Organization](#)

Christie Struckman, Daniel Sanchez Reina, and others.